

पेंशन निधि विनियामक और विकास प्राधिकरण

PENSION FUND REGULATORY AND DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

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🕒 11-03-2026 IST 18:23:41



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About the National Pension System (NPS)

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About NPS

National Pension System (NPS) is a defined contribution pension system. NPS was introduced by the Government of India in 2004 and is regulated and supervised by the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA). It is designed to enable systematic and regular savings during the working life of individuals to ensure a stable and adequate income post-retirement.



NPS is mandatory for Central Government employees joining services on or after 1st January 2004 and has been adopted by most of the State Governments for their employees. For more details, please refer [here](#).

NPS can be subscribed to by any Indian citizen (resident/non-resident/overseas) aged between 18 and 85 years on a voluntary basis. For more details, please refer [here](#).

NPS can be adopted on a voluntary basis by an Employer as a retirement benefit scheme for its employees. For more details, please refer [here](#).

Section 20(1) of the PFRDA Act, defines National Pension System (NPS) as 'the contributory pension system notified by the Government of India under the Ministry of Finance, notification number [F.N. 5/732002-FCPS-PS](#), dated 23.12.2004'.

NPS Architecture

The National Pension System (NPS) features a robust, unbundled system architecture designed to ensure efficiency, transparency, and cost-effectiveness. Each intermediary within the NPS ecosystem performs a distinct function to help reduce operational and intermediation costs, minimise systemic risks, and eliminate single points of failure.

This multi-layered architecture of NPS includes the following key entities:

- Constituted by PFRDA to safeguard the pension assets of NPS subscribers. The Trust oversees operational activities and is governed by a Board of Trustees appointed by PFRDA.
- Responsible for recordkeeping, administration, and subscriber services. Currently, three CRAs are registered with PFRDA:
- PFs manage the investment of pension contributions based on PFRDA's investment guidelines. At present, 10 Pension Funds are registered under NPS. [List of Pension Funds.](#)
- Provides banking services such as collection, pooling, remittance, and fund reconciliation within NPS. Axis Bank Ltd is currently appointed as the Trustee Bank.
- Act as distribution and service channels for NPS in the non-government sector. PoPs facilitate subscriber registration, contributions, and servicing. [List of PoPs.](#)
- Offers custodial and depository services by maintaining Demat accounts in the name of NPS Trust. Deutsche Bank is the current custodian of securities under NPS.
- Qualified individuals or entities registered with PFRDA to provide NPS advisory services and facilitate distribution of the pension scheme.
- Empanelled insurance companies are responsible for providing annuity payouts to subscribers upon exit from NPS.

For detailed guidelines and regulations related to NPS architecture, please refer to the [PFRDA regulations](#).

1. NPS Trust

2. Central Recordkeeping Agency (CRA)

- Protean eGov Technologies Limited
- KFin Technologies Limited
- Computer Age Management Services Limited

3. Pension Funds (PFs)

4. Trustee Bank (TB)

5. Points of Presence (PoPs)

6. Custodian

7. Retirement Advisors

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Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority

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